

A European trust layer for accountable AI

For policymakers focused on European digital sovereignty and the protection of citizens in the age of autonomous AI.

The problem, in one sentence

AI agents are starting to take **irreversible actions** — moving money, changing official records, deploying code, cutting off services — and today there is **no verifiable proof that a named, accountable human authorized any given action**. The record that “a human was in control” is a log the operator (often a non-European hyperscaler) keeps and could alter.

What EMILIA is

EMILIA is an open **authorization-receipt layer**: before an AI agent performs a consequential action, a *named, accountable human signs that exact action* on their own device. Afterwards, **anyone can verify, offline, who approved what** — without trusting the AI, the company that operates it, or EMILIA itself. **No receipt, no execution.**

Why this matters for Europe — and why it is undeniable

1. **It makes EU AI Act Article 14 real.** The Act *requires* meaningful human oversight of high-risk AI, but specifies **no artifact to prove it happened**. EMILIA is that artifact — a portable, tamper-evident receipt a regulator or court can check independently. It also maps to Article 12 (logging) and composes with eIDAS 2.0 / the EU Digital Identity Wallet for the human signature.
2. **It is sovereignty by construction.** Verification needs **no trust in the operator and no foreign cloud**. The proof is self-contained and checkable offline, on European soil, by European institutions. The software is open (Apache-2.0) and self-hostable — no dependence on, and no lock-in to, non-European hyperscalers. Europe holds the proof, not Big Tech.
3. **It protects citizens, not just companies.** When automation touches a citizen’s benefits, records, money, or rights, EMILIA guarantees a **named human stands behind that decision** — accountability against opaque, unaccountable machine action. A public-interest guarantee, not a vendor feature.
4. **It is a chance for Europe to lead the standard, not import it.** EMILIA is being contributed as an open standard at the IETF, with running code and conformance tests. Europe — and Bulgaria — can be **early authors** of the accountability standard the world will need, rather than adopting one written elsewhere.

What it is not (so the claim stays honest): EMILIA proves *authorization* — that the right human approved the exact action — not that the decision was wise or lawful. It is a **necessary, not sufficient**, condition for trustworthy AI: the verifiable foundation other safeguards build on.

The opening

A short conversation on where verifiable human authorization fits in Europe's AI sovereignty agenda — and whether a European public-sector pilot (a ministry, a grid operator, a public registry) would be a fit. **EMILIA does not charge public institutions** for the core protocol; the goal is adoption of the standard.

EMILIA Protocol · open source (Apache-2.0) · github.com/emiliaprotocol/emilia-protocol · emiliaprotocol.ai · team@emiliaprotocol.ai